

The Nature Color Wheel

Easy start · Outdoors · Grown-up nearby · Ages 4–8 · 20 min

Brought to you by Kiyah — “Look closer. Then draw what you saw.”

Collect color from outside instead of a paint box, and arrange it into a wheel.

WHAT YOU NEED

- A paper plate or circle of card
- Double-sided tape or a glue stick
- A bag for collecting
- Markers

BEFORE YOU START

Pick up things that have already fallen. Leave growing plants where they are.

A grown-up should check anything you find before you touch it, and nothing goes in mouths.

How to make it

- 1 Draw a circle on your plate and divide it into six wedges. Color each wedge a different color with markers.
- 2 Go outside and hunt for something that matches each wedge. Fallen leaves, petals, stones, bark, seed heads.
- 3 Stick each find into the wedge that matches it best.
- 4 Look at the two wedges you found hardest to fill. What colors were they?
- 5 Mix two of your marker colors together on scrap paper and see if you can make a color you were missing.
- 6 Hang the wheel up somewhere and add to it over the week as the seasons change what is on the ground.

TALK ABOUT IT

Which color was hardest to find outside, and why do you think nature has less of it?

TRY THIS TOO

Do it again in a different season, or in a different place, and hang the two wheels side by side.

DID YOU KNOW? · COLOR & LIGHT

Red, yellow, and blue mix into every other color. Those three are the starting points. Mix any two and you get orange, green, or purple. That is why a color wheel puts them opposite what they make, and why so few paints can produce so many colors.